Whole-class feedback

Responding to patterns in work

Use whole-class feedback when students' work reveals shared strengths and recurring difficulties. Review the pattern once, then give everyone a useful improvement task.

How to do it well

1 Review student work. Read the relevant body of work to identify common strengths, misconceptions and repeated errors; avoid annotating every piece in detail.

2 Record key feedback. Use a crib sheet for success criteria, what went well, model answers, misconceptions, key vocabulary, SPaG patterns and next actions.

3 Plan the response. Choose a model, comparison, live edit, brief reteach, discussion or practice task that will turn the pattern into learning.

4 Deliver feedback visibly. Use the board, visualiser, screen or handout to show strong examples and typical errors without exposing or embarrassing pupils.

5 Get pupils thinking and improving. Allocate time for a focused response: redraft, rehearse, revisit, re-learn or research, according to the learning need.

6 Reflect and respond. Check the improvements, decide what requires future teaching and revisit fragile learning through practice, retrieval or a hinge question.

What this sounds like

"This feature was secure across many responses. This next error appeared often, so we will model it, try a related question and then improve our own work."

Classroom example. An English assessment reveals a recurring weak explanation after evidence. The teacher selects a model and near-miss, improves the connection live and asks pupils to complete a fresh equivalent paragraph. Work is then returned for an individual improvement task. Feedback becomes instruction and practice rather than repeated comments on many scripts.

Top tips that make the technique work

Select a small number of high-value issues. Two or three important misconceptions can be more useful than reviewing every mark lost.

Prepare before returning scores. Deliver the model and recheck while attention is on learning rather than individual results.

Use barometer work carefully. Selected work can reveal patterns, but do not assume a small sample captures every need.

Model, recheck, stretch. Use a fresh equivalent question after the explanation, then a useful variation when secure.

Make errors retrievable. Review Cards turn selected individual gaps into future practice, beyond today's correction.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Choose the response from reviewed student work.	A presentation of comments with no improvement task.
Allocate time for students to act.	Reteaching every error for the same amount of time.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

DistillED - Whole Class Feedback | Barton - Whole-Class Feedback